

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER

Today, very humid, clouds and sun, a thunderstorm late, high 89. Tonight, warm and humid, low 76. Tomorrow, heavy thunderstorms, some sun, high 89. Weather map, Page A24.

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White House Pushing Back On Hemp Ban

Delay Stands to Benefit Chief of Staff’s Family

This article is by **Kenneth P. Vogel, Christina Jewett and Olivia Diaz.**

WASHINGTON — The White House is lobbying Congress for a reprieve from a ban it approved last year on potent intoxicating hemp products, seeking a delay whose beneficiaries would include the son-in-law of Susie Wiles, President Trump’s chief of staff.

Under pressure from the administration, senators tucked the delay into a stopgap spending measure they are working to pass this week in an effort to head off a government shutdown at the end of September.

The proposal has touched off an internal fight in Congress, with some senators balking at the idea of rolling back restrictions meant to address a public health risk, and could derail an agreement to quickly approve the spending bill. But its inclusion in the bill reflects the success of a hemp-industry influence campaign to avoid new regulations.

That campaign was led in part by Bret Worley, who married Ms. Wiles’s younger daughter, Caroline, in June at the Trump Winery in Charlottesville, Va. He is the chief executive of companies that distribute and sell intoxicating-hemp-derived gummies and vapes with names like Trainwreck and Blueberry Cookies.

While Mr. Trump does not drink or smoke, his administration’s advocacy for intoxicating hemp is in line with permissive stances it has adopted toward other intoxicants and wellness trends. The approach has concerned public health experts and is a departure from Republican orthodoxy.

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MYKOLA TYMCHENKO/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE — GETTY IMAGES

With Ukraine Air Defenses Thinned, Russia Attacks

Among the victims of a bombardment in the Kyiv region Wednesday were several whose bodies lay on a railway platform. Page A11.

U.S. Ends Work With Organ Donor Group Over Reports of Abuses

By **BRIAN M. ROSENTHAL**

The federal government is firing the nonprofit group that coordinates organ donations in Kentucky after finding that it tried to pursue organs from critically ill people who were recovering from their injuries.

The decision, announced on Wednesday, will effectively shut down the organization, called Network for Hope. It is part of a monthslong effort to address un-

safe and unfair practices in the United States organ transplant system.

Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., whose department oversees the transplant system, cut ties with a similar nonprofit in South Florida last year. Before that, the roughly 55 groups that have federal contracts to manage donations in the country had never faced closure.

“Today we are restoring integrity,” Mr. Kennedy said at an event in Lexington, Ky. “We will not tol-

Claims of Ignoring Signs of Patient Alertness

erate organizations that compromise patient safety or betray the trust of donors or their families.”

He said that Network for Hope had endangered patients and failed to fix safety lapses despite numerous opportunities to improve.

Network for Hope is planning to appeal the decision. The organization said in a statement that it had complied with all federal policies and enacted patient safeguards, and that “more than 3,000 people waiting for a lifesaving organ transplant will be negatively impacted by the decision announced today.”

In addition to Kentucky, the group also coordinates donations in more than a dozen counties in

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How Uber’s lawyers question women about their outfits

CALIFORNIA AUGUST 27, 2024

Q: Do you know if you had the bikini on at that time?

FLORIDA DECEMBER 16, 2024

Q: And what were you wearing?

A: Um, the planned outfit was joggers. But I don’t remember the top. I do remember the sneakers because the police took them away, and I really liked them.

MISSOURI JANUARY 17, 2026

Q: Do you remember if you were wearing underwear?

PRESSING VICTIMS IN COURTROOM

Uber Digs Deep Into Accusers’ Past In Fighting Sexual Assault Lawsuits

By **EMILY STEEL**

A 24-year-old woman logged onto a videoconference from her bedroom in Florida on a Friday morning in April 2025 to face a deposition in her lawsuit against Uber.

Her driver had already pleaded guilty in criminal court to raping her vaginally, anally and orally while she was unconscious during a ride in Tampa one night in 2021. He was in prison, serving a 10-year sentence. The woman, identified as Jane Doe in court documents, was suing Uber in civil

court for negligence, arguing that the company should have done more to screen and supervise the driver, a man with prior violent felony convictions.

Publicly, Uber proclaims itself to be a company devoted to handling sexual violence in a “survivor-centric” and “trauma-informed” way, supporting survivors and treating them with dignity. After years of fielding reports of sexual misconduct, the company developed instructional vid-

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By **LISA LERER**

For months, the Democratic establishment had issued increasingly dire warnings that Dr. Abdul El-Sayed, a progressive Michigan firebrand who had never won an election, would struggle to win a swing-state Senate seat that the party could not afford to lose.

The state’s governor, members of Congress and attorney general lined up behind his primary opponent, Representative Haley Stevens, a centrist from a swing district. They argued that she could win the kind of tough races that are a hallmark of this battleground state, where voters have twice voted for Donald J. Trump and twice voted for Ronald Reagan.

On Tuesday, a slim plurality of Democratic primary voters disagreed, betting with their hearts on a candidate whose fiercely progressive message had thrilled a coalition of younger and college-educated liberals.

Now, as Dr. El-Sayed heads into the general election, his

NEWS ANALYSIS

Win in Michigan Sets Up Left’s Real Test in Fall



NICK HAGEN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Dr. Abdul El-Sayed is Michigan’s Democratic Senate nominee.

candidacy will pose perhaps the most consequential challenge to the party’s ascendant progressive wing: Can an insurgent candidate, with unabashedly left-wing positions, win in a moderate state?

Dr. El-Sayed will offer the first general election test of the competing theories of electability

that have been debated among Democrats for nearly a decade. Since Senator Bernie Sanders exploded onto the national stage in 2016, progressives have argued that their party’s path to victory runs through a populist economic agenda that can attract a broad coalition of working-

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China’s Nonsmokers, Often Outnumbered, Try to Clear the Air

By **BERRY WANG**

HONG KONG — Amanda Zhang was planning a quiet dinner out with her mother, who had recently undergone surgery for lung cancer. But as Ms. Zhang walked through a shopping mall, she was suddenly confronted by clouds of cigarette smoke in the corridor outside the restaurant.

Worried about her mother’s

health, Ms. Zhang, a student in her 20s, approached the source, a middle-aged couple, and pointed out that smoking in indoor public areas was not allowed in Nanjing, a city in eastern China. When they persisted, she went into the restaurant, pulled out her phone and began photographing them through the window.

The man rushed inside and started berating her. He shoved

Disputes More Visible as Bans Remain Lax

his own phone in her face, taking photos. His family members, who were also eating at the restaurant, joined in the scolding. “If you don’t want to breathe smoke, stay home!,” his daughter can be heard

screaming in a video Ms. Zhang recorded, which was reviewed by The New York Times.

Such friction is not unusual in China, which consumes about half the world’s cigarettes and where enforcement of local smoking bans can be lax or virtually nonexistent. Smokers routinely light up at bus stops, elevators, parks, restaurants and even hospitals.

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INTERNATIONAL A4-11

End of a Kiwi Tradition

As New Zealand phases out greyhound racing, the government commits to dealing with the repercussions. PAGE A4

C.I.A. Secret Cuba Task Force

The spy agency is positioning itself to help create fissures in the island’s political elite. PAGE A7

NATIONAL A12-20, 24

Recalled Officials Won’t Leave

Avenal, Calif., a city in the rural Central Valley, has become an unlikely example of election denialism. PAGE A12

Witness in Washington Fires

A resident of Spokane County said he noticed a man acting suspiciously and called 911 after seeing smoke. PAGE A13

BUSINESS B1-6

The Hot New Tax Haven

U.S. companies like the shoemaker Crocs are turning to Malta, the smallest E.U. country, in a trend pushed by the Big Four accounting firms. PAGE B1



THURSDAY STYLES D1-6

Man’s Creepiest Friend?

Forget dogs and cats. Pet jumping spiders like Frida, above, are actually very lovable. But they won’t fetch. PAGE D2

New Era of Preppy Fashion

The madras, the red pants, the boat shoes — an enduring aesthetic is finding a new batch of devotees. PAGE D6

SPORTS B7-10

Steelers Coach’s Joy and Grief

Mike McCarthy’s return to Pittsburgh, where he grew up, fills him with pride but accentuates the loss of his brother. “It’s really heavy,” he said. “Everything reminds me of Joe.” PAGE B7

FIFA Owes Us, Host Cities Say

After the World Cup, committee executives in the United States are chasing soccer’s governing body for millions of dollars they believe they were promised as “legacy” payments. PAGE B8

OPINION A22-23

Ross Douthat

PAGE A22



ARTS C1-6

Where ‘Ted Lasso’ Suits Up

Fans of the TV comedy flock to Richmond-upon-Thames, the London suburb where the show is set. Above, merchandise at a series-themed shop. PAGE C1

